

D099

Sales Management

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

Before calling a hospital's supply director for the first time, a medical-device rep with ten years in the industry reviews the hospital's annual report, recent expansion news and the director's professional profile. The rep drives a company car. Which stage of the selling process is this?

- A. Approach.
- B. Follow-up.
- C. Prospecting.
- D. Pre-approach.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2.

A facilities coordinator at a large university downloads a white paper, attends a webinar and says she loves the product. She has no budget and says her dean makes all purchase decisions next fiscal year. The university has 30,000 students. How should the rep classify her?

- A. A top-priority prospect because the university is large.
- B. An interested lead who is not yet a qualified prospect; nurture and find the decision-maker.
- C. A fully qualified prospect, because she is enthusiastic.
- D. A lost cause to be removed from the CRM.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

Near the end of a demo, the operations manager of a family-owned trucking company, which runs 80 trucks, says, "This looks expensive." The rep's quarter ends in three days. What should the rep do first?

- A. Offer a 15% discount to close before quarter-end.
- B. Move on to the contract, since price objections always fade.
- C. Acknowledge the concern and ask what he is comparing it to or which costs worry him most.
- D. Explain that the price is fair and he is mistaken.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

A rep sells a \$250,000 warehouse automation system to a distributor whose order-picking errors have doubled. The distributor's headquarters recently moved to a new city. Which opening approach best fits this sale?

- A. Present every feature of the system in a standard pitch.
- B. Lead with the lowest price and a quick close.
- C. Focus on relocation services for the new headquarters.
- D. Ask questions about the picking errors, their causes and costs before proposing a solution.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

At a manufacturing company, the IT director set the technical specifications for new laptops, the CFO will choose the vendor, and a purchasing agent will issue the purchase order. The company is celebrating its 50th anniversary. Who is the decider?

- A. The CFO.
- B. Whoever has been with the company longest.
- C. The purchasing agent.
- D. The IT director.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

An executive assistant screens all vendor calls and decides which sales reps reach the vice president. Which buying-center role does the assistant hold?

- A. User.
- B. Gatekeeper.
- C. Decider.
- D. Buyer.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A rep earns a \$40,000 base salary plus 4% commission on all sales. She sold \$900,000 this year and won a regional sales award. Her territory covers three states. What is her total pay?

- A. \$76,000
- B. \$40,000
- C. \$37,600
- D. \$36,000

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A rep's plan pays a \$40,000 salary plus 5% commission on all sales. How much must the rep sell to earn \$100,000 in total?

- A. \$3,000
- B. \$1,200,000
- C. \$60,000
- D. \$2,000,000

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A distributor has 100 large accounts that need 24 visits a year and 200 small accounts that need 12 visits a year. Each rep can make 800 calls a year. The sales VP recently switched CRM vendors. How many reps are needed?

- A. 1
- B. It depends on the new CRM system.
- C. 3
- D. 6

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A company has 5 reps, each able to make 1,000 calls a year, and 250 accounts that all get the same number of visits. How many visits per year can each account receive?

- A. 4
- B. 0.05
- C. 20
- D. 50

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A pet-supply store's average customer spends \$50 per visit, visits 6 times a year and stays 4 years. The store's gross margin is 30%. It recently added a grooming salon. What is the customer's lifetime value in margin?

- A.** \$360
- B.** \$90
- C.** \$1,200
- D.** \$300

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	____	

12. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A subscription service earns \$150 a year in margin from each customer. Management wants each customer to be worth at least \$600 in lifetime margin. How many years must a customer stay?

- A.** 1 year, since any customer who stays is profitable
- B.** 0.25 years
- C.** 4 years
- D.** \$90,000

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	____	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer D Concept 1

Before calling a hospital's supply director for the first time, a medical-device rep ~~with ten years in the industry~~ reviews the hospital's annual report, recent expansion news and the director's professional profile. ~~The rep drives a company car.~~ Which stage of the selling process is this?

Target word: name the stage **Decides:** Research on a specific prospect before first contact.

A	Confusion set	The approach is the first contact itself.
B	Inverted operation	Follow-up happens after a sale, at the other end of the process.
C	Adjacent category	Prospecting finds potential customers; this prospect is already identified.
D	Correct	Planning and researching a known prospect before contact is the pre-approach.

2. Answer B Concept 2

A facilities coordinator at a large university downloads a white paper, attends a webinar and says she loves the product. She has no budget and says her dean makes all purchase decisions next fiscal year. ~~The university has 30,000 students.~~ How should the rep classify her?

Target word: qualification status **Decides:** Interest and need, but no budget, authority or near-term timing.

A	Camouflage	Organization size does not qualify this contact.
B	Correct	Missing budget, authority and timing means she does not meet BANT.
C	Dropped element	Enthusiasm shows need only; three BANT elements are missing.
D	Absolute language	An engaged lead can be nurtured and routed to the decider.

3. Answer C Concept 3

Near the end of a demo, the operations manager of a family-owned trucking company, ~~which runs 80 trucks,~~ says, "This looks expensive." ~~The rep's quarter ends in three days.~~ What should the rep do first?

Target word: first step with an objection **Decides:** Clarify what the concern really is before responding.

A	Camouflage	Driven by the rep's deadline; cuts price before understanding the objection.
B	Absolute language	Ignoring an objection leaves it unresolved.
C	Correct	Clarifying reveals whether it is budget, value or comparison before answering.
D	Inverted operation	Arguing puts the buyer on the defensive.

4. Answer D Concept 4

A rep sells a \$250,000 warehouse automation system to a distributor whose order-picking errors have doubled. ~~The distributor's headquarters recently moved to a new city.~~ Which opening approach best fits this sale?

Target word: selling approach for a complex sale **Decides:** High-stakes, problem-driven purchase calls for needs discovery.

A	Dropped element	Skips discovery and ignores the buyer's specific problem.
B	Adjacent category	Transactional selling suits simple, repeat purchases.
C	Camouflage	The move is irrelevant to the problem.
D	Correct	Consultative selling diagnoses the problem first.

5. Answer A Concept 5

At a manufacturing company, the IT director set the technical specifications for new laptops, the CFO will choose the vendor, and a purchasing agent will issue the purchase order. ~~The company is celebrating its 50th anniversary.~~ Who is the decider?

Target word: identify the buying-center role **Decides:** The CFO chooses the vendor.

A	Correct	The decider makes the final choice.
B	Camouflage	The anniversary detail does not decide roles.
C	Confusion set	The buyer handles the transaction but does not choose.
D	Adjacent category	Setting specs makes him an influencer.

6. Answer B Concept 5 • transfer

An executive assistant screens all vendor calls and decides which sales reps reach the vice president. Which buying-center role does the assistant hold?

Target word: reverse: name the role from the behavior **Decides:** Controls the flow of information and access.

A	Confusion set	Users are the people who will use the product.
B	Correct	Gatekeepers control access and information.
C	Inverted operation	The vice president decides; the assistant only controls access.
D	Adjacent category	The buyer places the order.

7. Answer A Concept 6

A rep earns a \$40,000 base salary plus 4% commission on all sales. She sold \$900,000 this year ~~and won a regional sales award. Her territory covers three states.~~ What is her total pay?

Target word: total compensation **Decides:** $\text{Base} + 4\% \times \$900,000$.

A	Correct	$\$40,000 + 0.04 \times \$900,000 = \$40,000 + \$36,000$.
B	Wrong stem number	Base only.
C	Inverted operation	Takes 4% of the base and adds it to commission instead of adding the base itself.
D	Dropped element	Commission only; leaves out the base.

8. Answer B Concept 6 • transfer

A rep's plan pays a \$40,000 salary plus 5% commission on all sales. How much must the rep sell to earn \$100,000 in total?

Target word: solve for sales **Decides:** $\text{Commission needed} = \$60,000$; $\text{sales} = \$60,000 \div 0.05$.

A	Inverted operation	Multiplies \$60,000 by 5% instead of dividing.
B	Correct	$(\$100,000 - \$40,000) / 0.05 = \$1,200,000$.
C	Confusion set	That is the commission needed, not the sales.
D	Dropped element	Divides the full \$100,000 by 5% and ignores the salary.

9. Answer D Concept 7

A distributor has 100 large accounts that need 24 visits a year and 200 small accounts that need 12 visits a year. Each rep can make 800 calls a year. ~~The sales VP recently switched CRM vendors.~~ How many reps are needed?

Target word: sales force size **Decides:** Total calls = $100 \times 24 + 200 \times 12 = 4,800$.

A	Confusion set	Divides 300 accounts by 800 calls — accounts, not calls.
B	Camouflage	Software choice does not change the workload math.
C	Dropped element	Counts only the large accounts' 2,400 calls.
D	Correct	4,800 calls / 800 calls per rep = 6.

10. Answer C Concept 7 • transfer

A company has 5 reps, each able to make 1,000 calls a year, and 250 accounts that all get the same number of visits. How many visits per year can each account receive?

Target word: solve for call frequency **Decides:** Total capacity 5,000 calls ÷ 250 accounts.

A	Dropped element	Uses one rep's 1,000 calls and drops the other four.
B	Wrong stem number	Divides 250 accounts by 5,000 calls, the inverse ratio.
C	Correct	$5 \times 1,000 = 5,000$; $5,000 / 250 = 20$.
D	Inverted operation	Divides accounts by reps instead of calls by accounts.

11. Answer A Concept 8

A pet-supply store's average customer spends \$50 per visit, visits 6 times a year and stays 4 years. The store's gross margin is 30%. ~~It recently added a grooming salon.~~ What is the customer's lifetime value in margin?

Target word: CLV **Decides:** $\$50 \times 30\% \times 6 \times 4$.

A	Correct	$\$15 \text{ margin} \times 6 \text{ visits} \times 4 \text{ years} = \360 .
B	Adjacent category	One year of margin, not the lifetime.
C	Dropped element	Lifetime revenue; leaves out the 30% margin.
D	Confusion set	One year of revenue ($\$50 \times 6$), with neither margin nor retention applied.

12. Answer C Concept 8 • transfer

A subscription service earns \$150 a year in margin from each customer. Management wants each customer to be worth at least \$600 in lifetime margin. How many years must a customer stay?

Target word: solve for retention years **Decides:** Years = $\$600 \div \150 .

A	Absolute language	One year yields only \$150 of the \$600 target.
B	Inverted operation	Divides \$150 by \$600.
C	Correct	$\$600 / \$150 = 4$.
D	Confusion set	Multiplies the figures instead of dividing.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	7	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	2	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	5	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	7	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	3	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	7	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	5	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Stages of the selling process	Prospecting, pre-approach, approach, needs discovery/presentation, handling objections, closing and follow-up occur in order, each with its own purpose.	Treating research on a prospect before first contact (pre-approach) as prospecting or as the approach.	What the rep is doing and whether contact has been made yet.
2	Lead qualification	A lead becomes a qualified prospect only when it shows need, budget, authority and timing (BANT); marketing-qualified leads are handed to sales once they meet agreed criteria.	Treating any interested contact as a qualified prospect.	A contact's interest described alongside missing budget, authority or timing.
3	Handling objections	Listen, acknowledge and clarify the real concern before answering it; many objections are requests for information.	Arguing immediately or cutting price at the first objection.	A buyer raises a concern and the options differ in how the rep responds first.
4	Consultative vs. transactional selling	Consultative selling diagnoses the buyer's problem through questions and tailors a solution; transactional selling focuses on price and speed for simple, known needs.	Leading a complex sale with a product pitch before discovering needs.	A complex, high-stakes purchase vs. a simple, repeat one.
5	The B2B buying center	Business purchases involve roles: initiator, user, influencer, gatekeeper, decider and buyer; one person may hold several roles.	Assuming the person who signs the purchase order makes the choice.	A named person who controls access, sets specs, approves, or places the order.
6	Sales compensation plans	Straight salary gives security and control; straight commission maximizes incentive and makes pay variable; combination plans blend both. $\text{Pay} = \text{base} + \text{rate} \times \text{qualifying sales}$.	Applying commission to the wrong base (all sales vs. sales above quota).	A base salary, a commission rate and a sales figure.
7	Sales force size: workload method	$\text{Number of reps} = \frac{\text{total annual calls needed (accounts} \times \text{call frequency)}}{\text{calls one rep can make per year}}$.	Dividing accounts, not calls, by rep capacity.	Account counts, visit frequencies and rep call capacity.
8	Customer lifetime value (CLV)	$\text{CLV} \approx \text{margin per purchase} \times \text{purchases per year} \times \text{years retained}$; it caps what is worth spending to acquire and keep a customer.	Using revenue instead of margin, or only one year of purchases.	Purchase size, frequency, margin and years a customer stays.

Course scope (public description): This course provides students with knowledge on the sales profession, customer relationship management, and sales management functions. Students gain insights into the sales process, the relationship between sales and marketing, and the responsibilities of sales management within both business-to-consumer (B2C) and business-to-business (B2B) selling environments.